UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION

Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System	Docket No. RM26-4-000

INITIAL COMMENTS OF
AMAZON ENERGY LLC

Pursuant to the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission's ("Commission") Notice Inviting Comments in the above-captioned proceeding, Amazon Energy LLC ("Amazon Energy") submits these initial comments on the proposed advance notice of proposed rulemaking ("ANOPR") issued by the Secretary of Energy on October 23, 2025.[1]

Amazon Energy appreciates the Commission's consideration of the important issues identified in the ANOPR, and the opportunity for Amazon Energy to provide input based on its relevant experience. Additionally, Amazon Energy thanks the Department of Energy for initiating a discussion on the need for timely, orderly, and non-discriminatory interconnection of large loads to the bulk electric system in a manner that respects jurisdictional boundaries. Amazon Energy supports reforms that, done right, will help the United States connect new AI and advanced manufacturing investment quickly, while strengthening grid reliability and affordability for all customers. Amazon Energy recognizes the challenges associated with the expected significant growth in electric demand and generation capacity due, in part, to critical AI workloads needed for national security and economic development, and to support the Administration's efforts to achieve national energy dominance.[2] The ANOPR is an important step in addressing those challenges.

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[1] Letter from Chris Wright, Secretary of Energy, Dep't of Energy, to Hon. David Rosner, Chairman, et al., Fed. Energy Regulatory Comm'n, Oct. 23, 2025 (on file with the Fed. Energy Regulatory Comm'n, Docket No. RM26-4-000).

[2] *See* America's AI Action Plan at 1, available at https://www.whitehouse.gov/wp-content/uploads/2025/07/Americas-AI-Action-Plan.pdf.

Amazon Energy respectfully recommends that any future action by the Commission in this proceeding (i) apply only on a prospective basis, (ii) implement a fast-track for ready projects and advanced technologies to accelerate the processing of interconnection requests, and (iii) standardize milestones and requirements and enhance visibility to improve the processing of large load interconnections and, in turn, improve transmission system planning and development and load forecasting.

I. COMMUNICATIONS

Communications regarding this matter should be addressed to the following people, who also should be designated for service on the Commission's official service list for this proceeding:

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Amazon Energy requests, to the extent necessary, that the Commission waive the requirements of Rule 203(b)[3] to permit each person named above to be placed on the official service list to avoid delays in responding to official documents and communications.

Amazon Energy is a wholly owned subsidiary of Amazon.com, Inc. and an affiliate of Amazon Data Services, Inc., a large load customer and data center operator in a number of jurisdictions throughout the United States.

[3] 18 C.F.R. § 385.203(b).

II. INITIAL COMMENTS

A. The Commission Should Not Apply Any Potential Reforms Retroactively to Large Load Projects Currently In Progress.

The instant proceeding is the first step in the Commission's consideration of initiating a rulemaking proceeding and, ultimately, issuing a final rule that would, as proposed, implement reforms to standardize procedures and agreements for large load interconnections to the bulk electric system.[4] Amazon Energy supports efforts to establish a clear process for efficiently interconnecting large loads to the interstate transmission system. The goal should be to remove any unnecessary delays and uncertainty that make it harder for utilities and grid operators to plan reliably and keep costs down for everyone.

Amazon Energy respectfully urges the Commission to apply any new rules or policy changes adopted in this proceeding prospectively, and not to large load interconnection requests currently in progress under existing interconnection procedures. Specifically, Amazon Energy proposes any new rules apply only to large load interconnection requests that, as of the effective date of the new rules, have not executed agreements that include a significant financial commitment to the interconnecting utility.

Large load developers have expended significant time and resources developing new large load projects (*e.g.*, completing feasibility and system impact studies, securing sites, permits, and long-lead equipment, and executing definitive agreements) and made substantial investments in reliance on existing interconnection rules and procedures. Abruptly subjecting these in-progress projects to new requirements or study processes could upend their economics, cause substantial delay, or even force withdrawals, thereby undermining the goals of timely and orderly interconnection that the ANOPR seeks to advance. Therefore, consistent with prior Commission policy to not disrupt projects currently in progress,[5] and to ensure that no project currently in progress is adversely impacted by the adoption of new large load interconnection

[4] *See* ANOPR at PP 1 and 12. *See id*. at P 30 (seeking comment on "the treatment of large load interconnections that are already being studied for interconnection").

[5] *See, e.g.*, *Improvements to Generator Interconnection Procedures and Agreements*, Order No. 2023, 184 FERC ¶ 61,054 (2023), *order on reh'g*, Order No. 2023-A, 186 FERC ¶ 61,199 (2024) (establishing transitional serial studies, transitional cluster studies, and withdrawal options for interconnection customers already in the generation interconnection queue at the time of compliance).

procedures, any reforms emerging from this proceeding should be implemented on a prospective basis, with appropriate grandfathering or transition mechanisms.

B. The Commission Can Accelerate Large Load Interconnections by Requiring Fast-Track Processing for Ready Projects and the Use of Advanced Technologies.

A stated objective of the ANOPR is to improve the timely and orderly interconnection of large loads.[6] Amazon Energy believes this can be achieved, in part, by (i) accelerating the processing of large load interconnection projects that demonstrate high readiness, and (ii) requiring the use of advanced technologies that can help streamline and expedite administratively burdensome interconnection study processes.

Amazon Energy recommends that any rule adopted by the Commission governing the interconnection of large loads include mechanisms like those in Order No. 2023 to prioritize projects that are ready for interconnection. Those reforms recognize that when speculative or non-viable projects clog the generation interconnection queue, they inhibit the advancement of truly ready projects, a dynamic that Order No. 2023 sought to correct by incentivizing only viable projects to remain in the generation interconnection queue.[7] Similarly, with respect to large loads, Amazon Energy encourages the Commission to include in any rule a "fast track" or priority processing track for large load projects that can demonstrate a high degree of readiness (*e.g.*, projects that have (i) committed customers, (ii) secured all necessary permits, (iii) site control, (iv) secured financing or corporate commitments, and/or (v) an executed service agreement).

Additionally, Amazon Energy encourages the Commission to leverage technology and process innovations to automate and accelerate large load interconnections. Large load interconnections involve intensive engineering analyses and coordination, which can become a bottleneck to the timely completion of large load interconnections. The Commission should incentivize or require transmission providers to deploy modern software tools, such as advanced grid modeling and AI-driven analysis, that can conduct feasibility

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6 *See* ANOPR at P 1.

7 *See* Order No. 2023 at PP 5, 509-12, 514-15 (2023). P 5 discusses large generator interconnection queue backlogs and associated uncertainty and delays; PP 509-12 explicitly find that "speculative interconnection requests" and "overcrowded interconnection queues" cause study delays and explain that withdrawal penalties are intended to ensure projects are "commercially viable"; PP 514-15 describe how the penalty structure is designed to incentivize early withdrawal of "non-viable interconnection requests," reducing late-stage withdrawals and restudies.

and system impact studies more expeditiously and efficiently. Amazon Energy emphasizes that greater automation is not a substitute for sound engineering judgment, but a way to expedite engineers' and planners' work by handling administratively burdensome tasks and analyses in hours or days rather than weeks or months. By leveraging automation and enforcing readiness requirements, the Commission can (i) ensure that commercially viable large load projects will move forward expeditiously, and (ii) mitigate or eliminate inefficiencies, burdensome administrative tasks, and undue delays in the processing of large load interconnection requests.

C. Standard Milestones and Requirements and Enhanced Visibility for Large Load Interconnections Will Improve Processing and Transmission System Planning and Development.

Amazon Energy supports the proposal in the ANOPR that, "like generating facilities, load and hybrid facilities should be subject to standardized study deposits, readiness requirements, and withdrawal penalties," noting that "[t]hese provisions deter speculative projects and provide transmission providers with more useful information to more accurately forecast demand on their systems."[8] A major challenge in generation interconnection queues has been the high attrition rate of projects and the submission of multiple speculative generation interconnection requests.[9] This pattern burdens the generation interconnection queue with non-viable projects and triggers cascading restudies when those projects drop out of the queue. Order No. 2023 directly addressed this problem by implementing withdrawal penalties and stricter readiness requirements to incentivize only serious, viable projects to stay in the generation interconnection queue or to withdraw early if they are not ready.[10]

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8 ANOPR at P 21.

9 *See Electric Transmission Interconnection Queues,* NAT'L CONF. OF STATE LEGISLATURES (updated Jan. 7, 2025), https://www.ncsl.org/energy/electric-transmission-interconnection-queues (last accessed Nov. 19, 2025); Joseph Rand, *Status and Drivers of Generator Interconnection Backlogs*, LAWRENCE BERKELEY NAT'L LAB. (June 12, 2023), https://www.energy.gov/sites/default/files/2023-07/Rand_Queued%20Up_2022_Tx%26Ix_Summit_061223.pdf (estimating over 70 percent of projects in generation interconnection queues are ultimately withdrawn or cancelled).

10 *See* Order No. 2023 at PP 336-38, 454, 462-64, 509-13.

Amazon Energy urges the Commission to consider imposing similar standardization and requirements here to ensure the timely and efficient processing of large load interconnection requests, particularly for interconnections within the same ISO/RTO. For example, requiring large load interconnection customers to make upfront study deposits, demonstrate a degree of project readiness (*e.g.*, site control or an executed facilities construction contract), and face withdrawal penalties if they exit after certain milestones will discourage non-viable or speculative large load requests. Improving the caliber of projects at entry will allow the processing of large load interconnections to function more efficiently, with fewer late-stage withdrawals and cascading adverse effects for later large load interconnection requests. Additionally, standardizing milestones and requirements for large load interconnections within a common ISO/RTO will lead to better transmission planning outcomes, and in turn, result in improved accuracy in load forecasting.

In addition to upfront eligibility criteria, Amazon Energy recommends that the Commission direct transmission providers to report non-confidential, aggregated data on the processing of large load interconnection request outcomes, such as withdrawal rates, success rates, and processing times. This information will allow for (i) more accurate transmission system and large load planning and development, and (ii) regulators and market participants to make more informed decisions regarding resource adequacy, load growth, and reliability.

Improving the quality of large load interconnection requests through stricter criteria and milestones and enhanced visibility into the processing of large load interconnections through standardized reporting will result in market efficiencies, shorter development timelines, and lower costs for consumers.

D. Amazon Energy Supports Optionality for Large Load Interconnections.

The ANOPR states that studying hybrid facilities based on the amount of injection and/or withdrawal rights "provides incentives for co-location with new generation facilities and ensures efficient buildout of the transmission system."[11] Amazon Energy supports co-location of large load projects.

[11] *See* ANOPR at P 22. *See id*. at P 12 (defining hybrid facilities as load that seeks "to share a point of interconnection with new or existing generation facilities").

Amazon Energy also recognizes there may be benefits for all ratepayers to interconnecting large loads directly to the bulk electric system in coordination with the interconnection of generation facilities. To that end, creating viable pathways to allow large load customers and generators to interconnect to the bulk electric system, and to study, model, and operate with some form of interrelationship would yield benefits for the bulk electric system as a whole, including reduced administration for utilities, RTOs/ISOs, and investors. Nonetheless, as noted in its Post-Technical Conference Comments in Docket No. AD24-11-000, Amazon Energy supports solutions that provide the most flexibility to meet the needs of customers and businesses, which can include co-location.[12] Therefore, in addition to the Commission taking prompt action in the instant proceeding, Amazon Energy respectfully encourages the Commission to expeditiously issue an order in the pending proceeding in Docket No. AD24-11-000, which would provide the industry with much needed guidance as to the viability of large loads co-locating at generating facilities going forward.

III. CONCLUSION

Amazon Energy respectfully requests that the Commission consider the comments above and factor them into its decision-making in the instant proceeding.

Respectfully submitted,

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12 *Large Loads Co-Located at Generating Facilities*, Post-Technical Conference Comments of Amazon Energy LLC, Docket No. AD24-11-000, at 1 (filed Dec. 9, 2024).